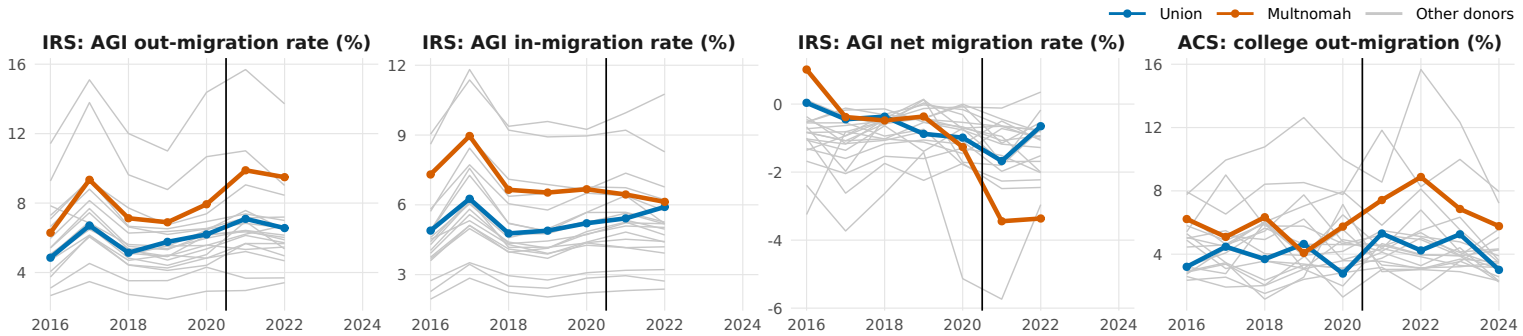
Union County, New Jersey

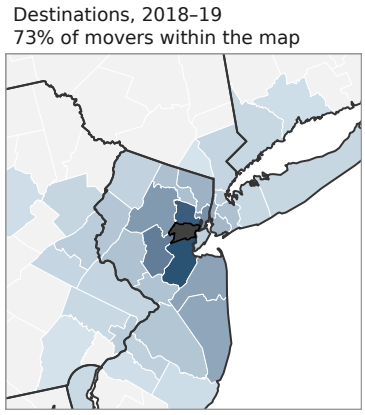
Used as a placebo: passes both pre-2020 screens

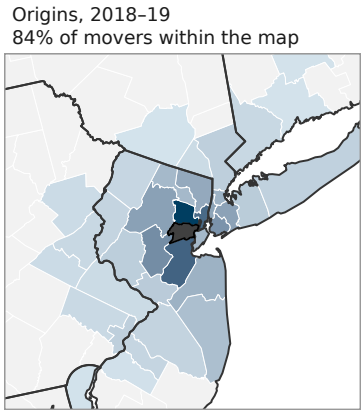
→ = 2018–19 to 2021–22 average	Union	Multnomah	Screens; College × Post DiD	This county	Multnomah
Population, 2020 Census	575,345	815,428	Used as a placebo (both screens)?	YES	
Density (people per sq. mile)	5,599	1,891	Origin county identified in the ACS?	yes	
Urban share of population	100%	99%	(a) Own pre-trend, joint p-value	0.14 — pass	0.39
Median household income (ACS)	$80,198	$69,176	(b) IRS slope distance from Multnomah	0.35 — pass	cutoff 0.43
Share under 24 / 65 and over	32% / 14%	27% / 13%	rank among donors (1 = closest)	6 of 20	
State top income-tax rate, 2019 / 2020 (%)	10.75 / 10.75	9.90 / 9.90	AGI out / in slope, 2016–19 (pp/yr)	0.12 / -0.15	-0.04 / -0.46
Governor's party, 2019 / 2020	D / D	D / D	In NJ or NY (top-rate rises 2020–21)?	YES	
Days under stay-at-home order	80	88	Other donor pools	stringency; demog.	
IRS AGI out-migration rate (%)	5.45 → 6.83	7.01 → 9.69	DiD, out-migration: pp (se)	-0.00 (0.62)	1.88 (0.57)
IRS AGI in-migration rate (%)	4.83 → 5.66	6.59 → 6.29	DiD, out-of-state: pp (se)	0.04 (0.42)	1.34 (0.44)
IRS AGI net migration rate (%)	-0.62 → -1.16	-0.42 → -3.40	DiD, in-migration: pp (se)	-0.0011 (0.0015)	-0.0028 (0.0020)

Migration rates before and after 2020

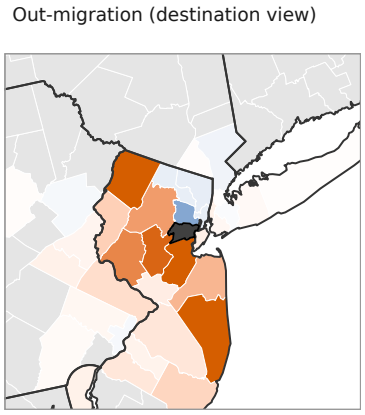


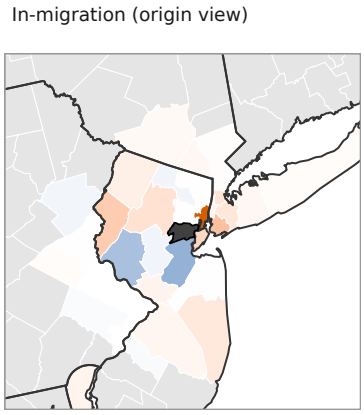
Where its movers went and came from





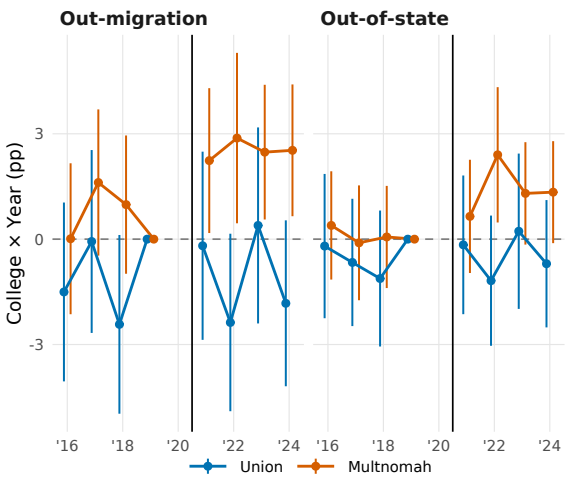
Change in AGI flows, 2018–19 to 2021–22 (as Figure 6)





% of movers	2018–19	2021–22	% of movers	2018–19	2021–22	Mult. pre	Mult. post
Top destinations			**Out-movers, to:**				
Middlesex, NJ	16.0	16.1	Border county	47	45	46	43
Essex, NJ	13.5	10.8	Within state	62	61	47	45
Somerset, NJ	7.9	7.9	Bordering state	11	11	27	27
Hudson, NJ	5.3	5.2	Top 10 flows	60	57	56	54
Morris, NJ	4.2	4.4	**In-movers, from:**				
Top origins			Border county	55	52	35	34
Essex, NJ	21.0	19.4	Within state	64	61	39	39
Middlesex, NJ	12.3	10.5	Bordering state	19	23	28	30
Hudson, NJ	11.1	12.1	Top 10 flows	70	70	48	48
Somerset, NJ	5.7	5.1					
Kings, NY	4.9	7.0					

Placebo event study (base 2019, 95% CI)



Sources: IRS SOI county migration files by filing year (rates as % of the county's base-year AGI; mover shares use returns); ACS 1-year PUMS, adults 25+.
Bordering-state shares are lower bounds (IRS disclosure). Change maps: grey = no flow reported in one or both windows.
DiD: 02_did_placebo.do, College × Year with the county as the focal county, 2016–2024 without 2020; bars are 95% confidence intervals.